

CRECHE WISE

Early Years Hive & Funding Automation

Claude Code Implementation Addendum

Additive requirements for NCS, ECCE, Core Funding, AIM and programme-readiness workflows

Product	Creche Wise
Document status	Implementation addendum - designed to extend the existing platform
Prepared for	First Stact Solutions / Claude Code implementation
Research current to	3 October 2026
Implementation principle	Reuse existing modules; additive migrations; no destructive rewrite

GOAL: make Creche Wise the operational source of truth that prepares Hive-ready information without duplicating data entry.

1. Purpose and instructions to Claude Code

This document is an implementation addendum to the existing Creche Wise platform. It does not replace the existing requirements or architecture. Claude Code must first inspect the current repository, database schema, authentication/tenant model, UI conventions, API patterns, test suite, payment/attendance modules and deployment pipeline, then implement this addendum in a way that is consistent with those existing choices.

NON-NEGOTIABLE IMPLEMENTATION RULE

Do not rebuild existing child, parent, attendance, billing, staff, room, calendar, document, notification or tenant functionality. Reuse and extend it. Introduce new funding/Hive domain objects only where the information does not already exist. Prefer foreign keys and derived views over duplicated copies of operational data.

1.1 Required development workflow

- Create a dedicated feature branch, recommended: feature/hive-funding-centre.
- Before coding, produce a repository impact assessment listing existing modules to reuse, new modules required, schema changes, API changes and UI routes.
- Use additive, reversible database migrations. Never drop or rename existing production fields without an explicit backwards-compatible migration plan.
- Implement behind a tenant-level feature flag until acceptance tests pass.
- Add unit, integration, cross-tenant, permission and end-to-end tests. The feature must not weaken existing tenant isolation.
- Create a pull request; do not commit the feature directly to main.
- Document any assumption where the repository implementation differs from this specification.

1.2 Product objective

Creche Wise should become the system in which the childcare provider maintains operational data once. The Funding & Hive Centre then derives, validates and presents the information required to complete Early Years Hive tasks. The initial release is a preparation, compliance and workflow layer. It must not pretend to submit data directly to Hive unless an approved integration mechanism is later provided.

2. Research summary: what providers currently maintain or submit

The current workload falls into four broad cadences: daily operational records, weekly NCS returns, event-driven registrations/claim changes, and periodic/annual programme-readiness and Core Funding activities. There is not one standard monthly Hive return. Creche Wise should therefore use event-driven and configurable deadline rules rather than a fixed monthly job.

Cadence	Provider responsibility	Creche Wise opportunity
Daily	Maintain attendance records including actual arrival/departure and sufficient audit information.	Capture once through existing attendance/check-in functionality; preserve immutable audit history.
Weekly	Submit NCS weekly return and report relevant leavers, continuous absences and persistent under-attendance.	Calculate exceptions automatically; create a weekly review queue and submission-ready snapshot.

Cadence	Provider responsibility	Creche Wise opportunity
On registration/change	Create/edit NCS claims, ECCE registrations and relevant child/programme information.	Pre-populate from child, schedule, fee and funding profiles; validate missing/contradictory fields.
Periodic	Core Funding Review & Confirm, application changes, Service Profile updates, AIM actions.	Maintain a shadow profile and compare operational records with the last confirmed funding snapshot.
Programme year	Programme Readiness: organisation/service details, PAU/users, bank, Tusla, fee table, service calendars, Parent Statement, agreements.	Provide readiness dashboard, evidence store, deadlines and change detection.

2A. Competitive landscape and product-gap mandate

Claude Code must treat existing Irish childcare software capabilities as the baseline, not the design target. Publicly advertised competitor functionality already includes NCS attendance calculations, under-attendance warnings, CHICK monitoring, Pobal-ready reports, Hive file reconciliation and one-click weekly Hive CSV exports. Creche Wise must therefore implement the Funding & Hive Centre as a proactive compliance automation layer rather than a collection of parity features. [S17][S18][S19][S20][S21][S22]

2A.1 Publicly demonstrated competitor baseline

Platform	Publicly advertised Hive / funding capability	Implication for Creche Wise
HavenLink	ECCE/NCS billing engine, automated NCS attendance status and one-click weekly HIVE CSV export. [S17]	Weekly return export is baseline functionality, not a differentiator.
CrecheHQ	HiveSync imports ECCE/NCS Hive files, matches registrations and reconciles hours/registration differences. [S18]	Import/reconciliation is useful, but Creche Wise must go beyond reactive reconciliation.
Tot Tracker	NCS attendance/compliance monitoring, eight-week alerts and a publicly announced future workflow intended to update schedules and Hive hours. [S19]	Threshold alerting alone is not sufficient; proactive impact detection must extend across all funding domains.
Little Vista	Automated NCS calculations, CHICK expiry management, under-attendance flagging, Pobal-ready reports and Core Funding compliance support. [S20]	CHICK alerts and reports are baseline; cross-module compliance consequences must be surfaced automatically.
Child Paths	NCS tracker, CHICK expiry alerts, attendance alerts and Pobal-ready reports. [S21]	NCS tracking/reporting is established market functionality.
EYCEsoft	Irish childcare platform built around ECCE/NCS funding management and compliance workflows. [S22]	Creche Wise must compete on automation quality and actionability, not merely scheme awareness.

Competitive-research caution: this table records capabilities publicly described on vendor websites as reviewed on 3 October 2026. The absence of a public claim does not prove that a competitor lacks a feature.

Claude Code must use this section as a product-design guardrail, not as a claim of exhaustive competitor functionality.

2A.2 Non-negotiable differentiation mandate

DO NOT BUILD FOR COMPETITOR PARITY

A feature is not complete merely because Creche Wise can export a Hive CSV, display NCS hours, warn about under-attendance, track a CHICK or import a Hive file. Those capabilities are baseline. The differentiator must be a continuous, proactive compliance engine that observes normal Creche Wise operational activity and tells the manager what changed, why it matters, which funding programme is affected, what action is required, by when, and which verified values/evidence are needed.

- Continuously evaluate funding consequences from changes in attendance, child schedules, fees, discounts, ECCE sessions, CHICK/award dates, staff records, qualifications, rooms, capacity, operating calendars and programme-year configuration.
- Create proactive warnings before a compliance threshold is breached where a reliable rule exists, not only after the breach. Example: show six-week and seven-week risk states before the eight-week NCS under-attendance action.
- Generate a single prioritised Hive Actions Required queue. Each action must include severity, programme, affected child/service/staff/room, rule version, due date, explanation, source evidence, recommended next step and completion status.
- Detect cross-module impacts automatically. Examples: a staff departure can affect Core Funding; a fee-plan change can affect NCS co-payment values and Fee Table/Parent Statement consistency; a room/capacity change can affect Core Funding; a service closure can affect the NCS Service Calendar and bridging-payment planning.
- Explain every alert in plain language: WHAT CHANGED, WHY IT MATTERS, WHAT THE PROVIDER SHOULD REVIEW OR DO, WHEN IT IS DUE, and WHICH VALUES CRECHE WISE HAS PREPARED.
- Prefer exception management over forcing the manager to inspect every child or funding record. Normal records should remain in a no-action group; attention should be directed to genuine exceptions and upcoming risks.
- Maintain immutable or versioned compliance snapshots so a manager can prove what Creche Wise calculated and what source data/rule version was used at the time.
- Make the rules engine programme-year aware and configurable so changes in NCS/ECCE/Core Funding/AIM rules do not require hard-coded rewrites across the application.
- Measure product success by administrative work removed and issues prevented, not by the number of funding screens implemented.

2A.3 Required proactive-compliance patterns

Operational event	Creche Wise proactive behaviour
NCS child reaches week 6 or 7 of under-attendance	Raise an approaching-threshold warning with claimed hours, actual hours, history and the date the eight-week threshold will be reached if the pattern continues.
NCS child reaches week 8 / continues to week 12	Promote to actionable/urgent compliance item with evidence snapshot and prepared Hive values.
CHICK or funding award approaches expiry	Create manager action and, where configured, parent reminder without exposing sensitive identifiers in notification text.

Operational event	Creche Wise proactive behaviour
Fee plan, discount or contracted hours change	Recalculate affected future co-payment values and flag any mismatch with prepared NCS claim / Fee Table / parent billing records.
ECCE session changes for a child with AIM Level 7 dependency	Require revalidation of the ECCE AM/PM funding preparation and show the potential AIM impact.
Staff member leaves or funded staffing data changes	Compare against latest Core Funding snapshot and create a Core Funding review item where staffing/capacity may be affected.
Room capacity/session/operating-weeks change	Compare with Core Funding shadow profile and surface drift before the next Review & Confirm window.
Service closure/calendar change	Re-evaluate NCS calendar implications, closure classification and any bridging-payment reminder rules.
Programme Readiness item becomes stale or incomplete	Show the exact missing/stale item and deadline rather than a generic incomplete status.

2A.4 Competitive-gap acceptance criteria

- A manager can open one dashboard and see the current funding actions that actually require attention without manually checking each child, room, staff member or scheme.
- At least one proactive pre-threshold state exists for NCS under-attendance and expiry-driven workflows where the rule can be calculated reliably.
- Funding actions are generated by underlying operational changes, not only by a user manually opening the Funding & Hive Centre.
- Every generated action is explainable and traceable to source data and a rule version.
- The implementation contains regression tests proving cross-module changes create the expected funding action and do not mutate unrelated live records.
- A parity-only implementation (reports/exports/alerts without cross-module impact detection and prioritised actions) must be treated as incomplete.

3. Current rules Creche Wise must model

3.1 NCS weekly returns and attendance exceptions

Current NCS policy requires providers to complete a weekly Provider Portal/Hive return. Published guidance states that returns become available from the last day of the reporting week (Sunday) and are due by the following Tuesday for payment to issue that week. If a return is not submitted in the required timeframe, subsidy payments can be suspended until it is submitted. [S1][S2]

The weekly return is primarily an exception/confirmation workflow rather than re-entering every clock-in. The provider must report relevant events such as a child leaving the service, a continuous absence of four or more consecutive weeks, and persistent under-attendance where a child attends less than registered NCS subsidised hours in each of eight consecutive weeks. The rules continue to a 12-week stage if the pattern persists. [S1][S3]

Implementation requirements

- Create a weekly NCS compliance calculation for every active NCS child.
- Store actual attendance minutes separately from any NCS-derived/rounded monitoring value.
- Track consecutive full-week absence count.
- Track consecutive under-attendance week count against the active NCS subsidised-hours schedule.

- Generate threshold alerts at four-week absence, eight-week under-attendance and 12-week continued under-attendance.
- Detect leaver/end-date events and place them in the next required Hive action queue.
- Support special-circumstances status with evidence metadata and start/end dates; do not silently suppress alerts without a recorded reason.
- Pause or treat service-wide closures according to the current rule configuration; do not count a full service closure as ordinary child under-attendance where the published rule says the sequence should resume after closure.
- Exclude ECCE/school hours from NCS attendance calculations where the child is not entitled to NCS subsidy for those hours.
- Make thresholds and submission deadline rules configuration-driven and versioned by programme year.

3.2 NCS daily attendance record requirements

Attendance evidence should retain the child, date, actual arrival time, actual departure time and the staff/user responsible for recording or amending the event. Creche Wise should preserve an edit trail. The raw timestamps are the authoritative operational record; any NCS rounded or derived value is a calculation and must never overwrite the raw record. [S1][S3]

3.3 NCS co-payment functionality introduced 31 July 2026

From 31 July 2026, new or edited NCS claims require mandatory co-payment information. The Hive functionality can calculate the weekly parental co-payment and takes account of education-stage changes, subsidy increases, variations in weekly claimed hours such as term/non-term patterns, applicable ECCE subsidies and service discounts. Providers can use fee information already held in the Hive Fee Table or manually enter fee information. Hive also provides co-payment printouts in PDF and CSV. [S4]

Fields Creche Wise must be able to prepare

Field/domain	Source in Creche Wise	Rule
Agreed/full fee before subsidies	Existing fee plan / child contract	Must be versioned for effective dates.
Corresponding childcare hours/minutes	Existing schedule / contract	Use the arrangement relevant to the claim period.
NCS subsidised hours	NCS funding profile	Support term-time and non-term-time variations.
ECCE subsidy where applicable	ECCE registration/profile	Do not double-count ECCE hours as NCS attendance.
Service discounts/deductions	Billing/discount engine	Represent sibling or other permitted discounts explicitly.
Calculated weekly parent co-payment	Derived calculation	Store formula inputs and result snapshot; allow verified override only with audit reason.
Claim start/end/effective dates	NCS claim record	No ambiguous overlap; maintain history.

3.4 NCS claim/registration preparation

Creche Wise should maintain the provider-side information required to prepare an NCS registration/claim, including child identity, DOB, CHICK, agreed subsidised hours, effective dates, attendance pattern and

fee/co-payment inputs. The provider should be able to mark a prepared record as verified and then as externally submitted to Hive. Do not mark a record submitted automatically unless the user confirms the Hive action was completed.

3.5 ECCE registrations

Published ECCE registration guidance requires completion of parent details, child details, child PPSN, address/Eircode, the registration period and registration-period data. Current 2026/2027 guidance also emphasises selecting the correct ECCE AM/PM session for children availing of AIM Level 7 because the session can affect AIM funding. [S5][S6]

SENSITIVE DATA

Child PPSNs are high-risk identifiers. If Creche Wise stores them, use encryption at rest at the field/application layer where supported, mask by default in the UI, log every reveal/export, restrict access by permission, and apply a documented retention/deletion rule.

3.6 Programme Readiness 2026/2027

Before funding agreements can be activated, current 2026/2027 Programme Readiness guidance requires providers to ensure organisation details, service-provider details, the Primary Authorised User, portal users, bank account, Tusla registration and ECCE minimum numbers where relevant are up to date, and to submit the programme-year Fee Table and Service Calendar(s). The Parent Statement must also be updated. [S7]

3.7 Core Funding

Core Funding uses the Service Profile and Core Funding Application Module. Current guidance describes service-level and staff information in the Service Profile, while capacity and age ranges are captured at room/session level in the application. Providers must periodically Review & Confirm their information; the 2026 May process required the Service Profile and most recent application to be accurate and approved, with update-due-date actions such as replacing departed staff or reducing capacity. The August 2026/2027 Review & Confirm also required the Service Profile to be up to date and the Fee Table/Parent Statement completed. [S8][S9][S10]

3.8 AIM

AIM applications are administered through the Early Years Hive. The Access and Inclusion Profile may include the child's personal details, parent/guardian details, information about physical abilities, communication, social skills, behaviour and health, and may include relevant professional reports or observations. AIM Level 7 underwent a simplification process in 2026. [S11][S12]

3.9 Direct Hive integration is not assumed

The Public Service Body Data Catalogue currently lists both the National Childcare Scheme dataset and the Early Years Platform as having no API available. Therefore Version 1 of this feature must prepare, validate and export information, not use screen scraping or undocumented automation to log into Hive. [S13][S14]

ARCHITECTURE DECISION

Create an Integration Adapter interface now, but ship a ManualHiveAdapter first. If an approved API/import mechanism is introduced later, add a new adapter without changing the core funding domain.

4. New Creche Wise module: Funding & Hive Centre

4.1 Navigation and scope

Add a top-level or administration-level module called Funding & Hive Centre. Visibility must be permission-based and tenant-scoped. The centre should aggregate existing data rather than own duplicate versions of the child, parent, attendance, room, staff, invoice or calendar records.

Screen	Purpose	Primary actions
Funding dashboard	Single view of NCS, ECCE, Core Funding, AIM and programme readiness.	Review alerts; open required actions; filter by programme/year/status.
NCS weekly return	Prepare weekly exception list and evidence.	Review; resolve warning; mark verified; mark submitted externally.
NCS claims & co-payments	Prepare claim inputs and parent co-payment calculations.	Create/edit funding profile; calculate; compare to billing; produce printout.
ECCE registrations	Prepare ECCE registration information.	Validate identity/address/session; generate registration pack; mark submitted.
Programme readiness	Track annual preconditions and documents.	Checklist; evidence upload; expiry/renewal reminder.
Core Funding	Maintain shadow profile and change detection.	Compare operational data to last funding snapshot; prepare R&C action list.
AIM cases	Maintain structured AIM preparation information.	Track consent, application status, supporting evidence, changes.
Hive action queue	Cross-programme worklist of things a manager must do.	Assign; verify; snooze with reason; complete; evidence upload.
Exports & evidence	Generate provider-ready packs and maintain audit copies.	PDF/CSV; download; hash/version; mark linked to submission.

4.2 Dashboard behaviour

The dashboard must be exception-driven. It should answer: what must the manager do now, what deadline is approaching, what funding record no longer matches operational reality, and what can be safely ignored because no action is required.

Widget	Example
NCS weekly return	Week 28 Sep - 4 Oct: 74 active NCS children; 69 clear; 5 require review.
Attendance thresholds	1 child at 4-week absence; 2 at 8-week under-attendance; 1 approaching 12 weeks.
Claims/co-payments	3 new/edited claims need co-payment inputs; 1 differs from billing contract.
ECCE	2 registrations ready; 1 missing PPSN; 1 AIM L7 child missing AM/PM session.

Widget	Example
Core Funding	1 staff departure may require replacement or capacity reduction; 1 room operating-weeks change.
Programme Readiness	Fee Table ready; service calendar ready; Parent Statement outstanding; Tusla field expiring/review required.
AIM	2 active cases; 1 consent/evidence item outstanding.

5. Data model changes

The following is a logical model. Claude Code must map these concepts into the existing repository naming conventions and avoid creating duplicate tenant, child, parent, staff, room, attendance, invoice or calendar tables if equivalents already exist.

5.1 FundingProgrammeConfig

Field	Type/notes
id	UUID or repository-standard key
tenant_id	Required; enforce tenant isolation
programme	NCS ECCE CORE_FUNDING AIM
programme_year	e.g. 2026/2027
active	Boolean
rules_version	Version identifier for business-rule set
submission_deadline_config	JSON/config reference, not hard-coded globally
created_at / updated_at	Auditable timestamps

5.2 ChildFundingProfile

Field	Notes
tenant_id / child_id	Required composite scope; child must belong to same tenant
ncs_chick	Masked; encrypted if architecture supports it
ncs_award_expiry	Optional until known
ncs_claimed_hours	Current effective value; history lives in claim versions
ncs_parent_confirmation_status	UNKNOWN PENDING CONFIRMED NOT_REQUIRED
ecce_eligible / ecce_registered	Boolean/status
ecce_ppsn_reference	Encrypted sensitive field or secure vault reference
ecce_session	AM PM other future-configurable value
aim_status	Summary only; detailed data in AIM case

Field	Notes
effective_from / effective_to	Support historical funding periods

5.3 NcsClaimVersion

Field	Notes
child_id	Existing child FK
status	DRAFT READY VERIFIED SUBMITTED_EXTERNALLY SUPERSEDED
start_date / end_date	Effective period
term_hours / non_term_hours	Weekly subsidised-hour pattern
weekly_fee	Full/agreed fee input
weekly_childcare_minutes	Exact scheduled minutes for fee period
ecce_subsidy_amount	Where applicable
discount_amount	Explicitly itemised
calculated_copayment	Derived
manual_override_amount	Nullable; requires permission + reason
override_reason	Required when override used
source_fee_plan_id	Existing billing fee plan where applicable
prepared_at / verified_by / external_submitted_at	Audit lifecycle

5.4 NcsWeeklyComplianceSnapshot

Field	Notes
child_id / week_start	Unique per tenant-child-week
actual_attendance_minutes	Derived from raw attendance
ncs_monitoring_hours_or_minutes	Derived according to active rules version
claimed_hours	Hours effective for that week
under_attended	Boolean
full_week_absent	Boolean
consecutive_under_attendance_weeks	Calculated
consecutive_absence_weeks	Calculated
threshold_event	NONE ABSENCE_4 UNDER_8 UNDER_12
service_closure_effect	NONE PAUSE_SEQUENCE other configured handling

Field	Notes
special_circumstances_status	None/pending/approved/rejected where tracked
calculation_version	Rules engine version

5.5 HiveActionItem

Field	Notes
programme	NCS/ECCE/Core/AIM
action_type	e.g. NCS_RETURN_EXCEPTION, ECCE_REGISTRATION, CORE_PROFILE_CHANGE
entity_type / entity_id	Child, staff, room, service etc.
severity	INFO ACTION URGENT
due_at	Nullable but preferred
status	OPEN IN_REVIEW VERIFIED COMPLETED DISMISSED_WITH_REASON
reason_code / description	Human-readable explanation
assigned_to	Optional tenant user
evidence_document_id	Optional existing document FK
completed_by / completed_at	Audit fields

5.6 SubmissionSnapshot / EvidencePack

Every prepared Hive action that matters financially or for compliance should be snapshot-able. Store a canonical JSON payload plus rendered PDF/CSV where generated, data-source version identifiers, the user who verified it, timestamp, and optional evidence that the provider completed the action in Hive. This protects the operational records from being frozen while preserving what was actually prepared at the time.

5.7 CoreFundingShadowProfile

- Do not duplicate all HR/room data. Store the last verified/submitted Core Funding snapshot and derive the current candidate profile from live operational data.
- Compare service-level operating weeks/hours, rooms, sessions, staffed capacity, age ranges and staff information.
- Create change events when a staff member leaves, hours change, room capacity changes, session changes or operating weeks change.
- Allow the manager to classify a change as: no Core Funding impact, review required, application change required, or externally completed.

5.8 AimCase

AIM information can include health and developmental information. Implement as a restricted domain with separate permissions, field-level masking where relevant, explicit parent/guardian consent metadata,

secure document links and an audit log. Reuse existing child and guardian records; never copy general health data into AIM merely for convenience.

6. Calculation and rules engine requirements

6.1 Attendance source of truth

Use the existing attendance events as the source of truth. Never derive raw attendance from a funding claim. The funding engine reads attendance; funding data does not rewrite attendance history.

6.2 Weekly NCS calculation - reference logic

Implement the following as a versioned service, not as scattered controller/UI logic:

```
for each active NCS child and reporting week:
  load effective NCS claim hours and schedule
  load raw attendance events for the week
  subtract/exclude ECCE or school hours that are not NCS-subsidised
  calculate actual minutes and NCS monitoring value under the active rules version
  determine whether the child met the registered NCS hours
  update consecutive under-attendance sequence
  determine whether the child had a continuous full-week absence
  update consecutive absence sequence
  apply service-closure and special-circumstances rules
  emit threshold events/actions at 4, 8 and 12 weeks as applicable
  persist an immutable weekly calculation snapshot
  never auto-submit to Hive
```

6.3 Rule configuration

Create a FundingRules provider keyed by programme year/effective date. Minimum configurable values should include weekly return deadline behaviour, absence threshold, under-attendance warning threshold, continued under-attendance threshold, rounding policy, closure handling, service closure allowance parameters, and required co-payment fields. Business-rule changes must not require rewriting historical snapshots.

6.4 Co-payment reconciliation

The co-payment calculator must reconcile three domains: the childcare contract/fee plan, state supports, and the invoice actually charged to the parent. If the calculated parent co-payment differs from the active billing arrangement beyond an allowed tolerance, create an action item rather than silently changing the invoice or claim.

7. Workflows

7.1 Weekly NCS return workflow

1. System creates reporting week automatically after the week ends.
2. Run compliance calculation for every active NCS child.
3. Children with no exception remain collapsed as "No action".
4. Children meeting leaver/absence/under-attendance/change criteria appear in Review Required.

5. Manager opens each exception, sees raw attendance, derived values, active claim, rule explanation and recommended Hive action.
6. Manager resolves missing data or confirms the exception.
7. System creates a submission snapshot/pack and marks return READY.
8. A permitted user marks VERIFIED.
9. After completing Hive, user marks SUBMITTED EXTERNALLY and may attach a screenshot/PDF/reference note as evidence.
10. Completed weekly return becomes read-only except for an auditable correction note.

7.2 New/edited NCS claim workflow

1. Select child; system loads child identity, CHICK/funding profile, schedule and active fee plan.
2. User selects/effective-dates the term/non-term claimed-hours pattern.
3. System prepares mandatory co-payment inputs and calculates parent co-payment.
4. Validate against current billing and ECCE profile.
5. If required data is missing, block READY status and list exact fields.
6. Generate Hive-ready claim summary with source values and audit timestamp.
7. User completes/edits claim in Hive and marks the Creche Wise record submitted externally.

7.3 ECCE registration workflow

1. Pre-populate parent and child details from existing enrolment.
2. Request/validate PPSN only if ECCE registration requires it and current tenant policy permits storing it.
3. Pre-populate address/Eircode, registration period and session.
4. If AIM Level 7 is relevant, require explicit confirmation of ECCE AM/PM session before READY.
5. Generate a registration pack/checklist and record external submission status.

7.4 Programme Readiness workflow

At the start of a new programme year, create a readiness instance per participating programme. Seed checklist items from the rule configuration. Link each checklist item to its source record where possible and show one of: Current, Review Required, Missing, Submitted, Not Applicable.

7.5 Core Funding change detection

When relevant existing records change, publish domain events into the Funding & Hive Centre. Examples: staff departed, manager changed, staff hours/role changed, room capacity changed, room/session created/closed, operating weeks changed, facility attributes changed. Evaluate whether the change differs from the latest verified Core Funding snapshot and create a review action if so.

8. UI requirements

8.1 Funding dashboard

Use existing Creche Wise design system/components. Do not introduce a separate visual language. The main dashboard should have programme cards, an action queue, upcoming deadlines, and clear links back to source records.

8.2 NCS child funding panel

On an authorised child profile, add a Funding tab or panel showing NCS/ECCE status, current claim period, weekly claimed hours, CHICK masked by default, co-payment summary, attendance compliance state, next relevant date and open Hive actions. Medical/operational child information must remain in its existing modules.

8.3 Explainability

Every automated alert must include "Why am I seeing this?" and show the calculation inputs. For example: "8-week under-attendance alert: claimed 40 hours; derived NCS attendance values for the last eight reporting weeks were 34, 36, 32, 35, 33, 37, 31 and 35." Users must never be asked to trust a black-box compliance result.

9. Notifications and reminders

Trigger	Recipient	Default behaviour
Weekly NCS return ready	Funding manager/tenant admin	In-app + email according to tenant preferences.
Tuesday NCS deadline approaching	Assigned responsible user	Escalating reminder if return not marked submitted.
4-week absence threshold	Funding manager	Action item; optional parent workflow remains separate.
8-week under-attendance	Funding manager	Action item with evidence and next-stage warning.
12-week continued under-attendance	Funding manager	Urgent action with full 12-week history.
New/edited NCS claim missing co-payment data	Funding manager	Block readiness and show missing fields.
ECCE AIM L7 registration missing AM/PM	Funding manager	Block readiness.
Core Funding-impacting staff/room change	Manager/owner	Create review action; do not auto-change funding data.
Programme-readiness deadline	Owner/PAU-equivalent role	Reminder based on configurable deadline.

10. Exports and Hive-ready packs

Version 1 must make manual Hive work fast and reliable. Provide exports only from verified snapshots, not from mutable live data at download time.

- NCS weekly return review pack (PDF) with exception summary, child-level evidence and calculation version.
- NCS claim/co-payment summary (PDF and CSV where useful).
- ECCE registration checklist/summary.
- Programme Readiness checklist and evidence index.
- Core Funding comparison report: last verified snapshot vs current operational data.
- AIM case preparation checklist with permissions appropriate to sensitive data.
- Audit export showing who prepared, verified and marked externally submitted.

11. Permissions, privacy and tenant isolation

This module inherits the existing multi-tenant model and must pass the Creche Wise cross-tenant security suite. It introduces additional sensitive information, therefore permissions must become stricter rather than broader.

Permission	Example capability
funding.view	View non-sensitive funding dashboard and action counts.
funding.manage_ncs	Prepare and verify NCS data.
funding.manage_ecce	Prepare ECCE registrations.
funding.view_sensitive_identifiers	Reveal PPSN/CHICK where policy permits.
funding.manage_core	Manage Core Funding snapshots/actions.
funding.manage_aim	Access restricted AIM case data.
funding.export	Generate/download verified funding exports.
funding.mark_submitted	Mark an item completed externally and attach evidence.
funding.override_calculation	Exceptional permission; mandatory reason and audit log.

11.1 Security requirements

- Every funding query must scope by authenticated tenant in addition to resource ID.
- A user must not access another tenant's child funding profile, Hive actions, snapshots, exports, staff profile or programme readiness record even with a guessed UUID.
- PPSN and similar sensitive identifiers must never be included in ordinary logs, analytics or error messages.
- Signed download links must be tenant/user authorised and short-lived.
- Audit all reveal, export, override, verification and external-submission actions.
- AIM data must use a narrower permission set than general funding data.
- Cross-family parent access remains prohibited; the Funding & Hive Centre is primarily an administrative function.

12. Integration with existing Creche Wise modules

Existing module	Reuse requirement	New behaviour
Children / enrolment	Use existing child identity, DOB, address and guardian relationships.	Add funding profile reference and readiness validation.
Attendance	Use raw check-in/out and edit audit trail.	Add weekly funding calculation service and compliance snapshots.
Billing / payments	Use fee plan, discounts, invoices and reconciliation.	Add co-payment calculation/reconciliation and mismatch alerts.
Rooms / sessions	Use room, capacity, schedule and session records.	Feed Core Funding shadow profile and ECCE session validation.
Staff / HR	Use role, hours, status, qualifications and compliance data.	Detect funding-impacting changes and prepare Service Profile comparisons.

Existing module	Reuse requirement	New behaviour
Calendar	Use service operating calendar and closures.	Generate/compare programme Service Calendar and closure actions.
Documents	Use existing secure document storage.	Store Parent Statement, consent/evidence and submission packs.
Notifications	Use existing channels/preferences.	Add funding action/deadline templates.
Audit log	Use existing append-only pattern.	Add funding-specific event types and sensitive-data access events.
Multi-tenancy/RBAC	Reuse existing tenant and permission middleware.	Add funding permissions; no alternate auth path.

13. APIs and service boundaries

Exact routes must follow the repository conventions. The following logical services should exist even if implemented as internal application services rather than public endpoints:

- FundingRulesService - resolve business rules by programme/effective date.
- NcsComplianceService - calculate weekly attendance compliance snapshots.
- NcsCopaymentService - calculate co-payment inputs/results and reconcile billing.
- HiveActionService - create/dedupe/assign/resolve action items.
- FundingSnapshotService - create immutable verified snapshots and export payloads.
- ProgrammeReadinessService - evaluate checklist readiness.
- CoreFundingComparisonService - compare live operational data to last verified snapshot.
- HiveIntegrationAdapter - interface; ManualHiveAdapter is the initial implementation.
- FundingAuditService - centralise sensitive-domain audit events.

14. Migration and backward-compatibility plan

- Phase 1 migrations only add tables/columns/indexes; no destructive schema changes.
- Existing tenants start with the Funding & Hive feature disabled unless explicitly enabled.
- Backfill child funding profiles only when there is reliable source data; otherwise create an onboarding action rather than guessing.
- Historical attendance remains untouched. Weekly snapshots can be back-calculated only when source attendance quality is sufficient and the user requests it.
- Do not retroactively infer that an old NCS action was submitted to Hive. Historical records should default to UNKNOWN/UNVERIFIED.
- All new scheduled jobs must be idempotent and tenant-safe.
- Provide rollback migrations for schema additions where the project standard permits.

15. Scheduled jobs

Job	Cadence	Behaviour
NCS weekly compliance build	After reporting week closes; configurable time	Calculate idempotent snapshots; create action items.
NCS deadline reminder	Configurable relative to deadline	Only remind tenants with an open/ready unsubmitted return.

Job	Cadence	Behaviour
Funding rule deadline scan	Daily	Create upcoming Programme Readiness/Core/AIM reminders.
Core Funding drift scan	Daily or event-driven	Compare funding-relevant changes to last snapshot; dedupe alerts.
Sensitive identifier expiry/award expiry scan	Daily	Notify only authorised users; never expose identifier value in notification.

16. Validation rules

- A funding record cannot reference a child, staff member, room, fee plan or document from another tenant.
- READY NCS claim requires all mandatory co-payment inputs under the effective rules version.
- ECCE registration requiring AIM L7 session must not be READY without confirmed AM/PM session.
- A weekly NCS return cannot be VERIFIED while unresolved ERROR-level calculation/data-quality issues remain.
- A submitted snapshot cannot be silently modified; corrections create a new version or correction record.
- Manual calculation overrides require explicit permission, reason, old value, new value and audit event.
- If operational billing and prepared co-payment disagree, show the mismatch; do not silently align one to the other.
- If a rule is unknown or source data is incomplete, fail safe with REVIEW REQUIRED rather than an invented answer.

17. Test requirements

17.1 Unit tests

- Consecutive 4-week absence detection.
- Under-attendance sequence resets after a compliant week.
- 8-week threshold action generation.
- 12-week continued under-attendance action generation.
- Service closure handling does not incorrectly reset/count a sequence under the configured rule.
- Term/non-term NCS hours switch on correct effective date.
- ECCE hours excluded from NCS attendance calculations where required.
- Co-payment calculation uses fee, hours, ECCE subsidy and discounts correctly.
- Claim edits after the mandatory effective date require co-payment fields.
- Rule versions reproduce historic calculations.

17.2 Integration tests

- Attendance event -> weekly compliance snapshot -> Hive action item.
- Staff departure -> Core Funding drift detection -> review action.
- Fee plan change -> NCS claim mismatch -> action item without invoice mutation.
- ECCE registration preparation pulls correct parent/child/address/session data.
- Programme Readiness pulls organisation/service/calendar/fee-table status from current records.
- Verified snapshot export remains unchanged after live operational data later changes.
- Week-6/week-7 NCS under-attendance risk state is created before the week-8 action threshold.
- Service calendar change -> NCS calendar/closure impact action where configured.
- CHICK/award expiry approaching -> proactive manager action and optional parent reminder.

- Room/capacity/operating-weeks change -> Core Funding drift action with source comparison.

17.3 Cross-tenant and permission tests

- Tenant A cannot view/change/export Tenant B funding profiles, action items, snapshots or AIM cases.
- Tenant A cannot attach Tenant B child/staff/document IDs to a funding record.
- A user without sensitive-identifier permission cannot reveal/export PPSN/CHICK.
- A user with NCS permission but without AIM permission cannot access AIM case content.
- Signed export URL for one tenant cannot be reused by another tenant.
- Scheduled jobs never mix action items or recipients across tenants.

17.4 End-to-end acceptance scenarios

Scenario	Expected result
Normal NCS child attends claimed hours	No exception; child remains in no-action group.
Child absent 4 consecutive weeks	Four-week action generated with evidence and rule explanation.
Child under-attends 8 consecutive weeks	Eight-week action generated; prior eight snapshots visible.
Under-attendance continues to week 12	Urgent 12-week action generated with full history.
New NCS claim after 31 Jul 2026	Cannot reach READY until co-payment fields validate.
ECCE + NCS child	ECCE session/subsidy represented; NCS attendance excludes non-subsidised ECCE hours.
AIM L7 ECCE child missing session	ECCE registration blocked from READY until AM/PM confirmed.
Room operating weeks changed	Core Funding comparison flags drift from latest snapshot.
Manager completes Hive action	User can mark submitted externally and attach evidence; snapshot locked.
No official API configured	Application never attempts undocumented automated Hive login/submission.
Child reaches week 6/7 of under-attendance	Approaching-threshold warning appears before the week-8 compliance action.
Fee/discount/contracted hours change	Affected co-payment/funding records are recalculated or flagged for review; unrelated invoices are not silently mutated.
CHICK/award approaches expiry	Proactive action is created with due date; configured parent reminder contains no sensitive identifier.
Staff member leaves a funded room	Core Funding impact action is generated without the manager manually opening the funding module.
Service closure is added/changed	Service Calendar/bridging-payment impact is re-evaluated and surfaced if relevant.

18. Phased implementation plan

Phase	Scope	Release gate
Phase 0 - discovery	Repository impact assessment; map existing child/attendance/billing/staff/room/calendar/security modules; identify where proactive funding events can subscribe to existing domain changes.	No code until duplication risks, event sources and migration plan are documented.
Phase 1 - NCS compliance	Funding profile, weekly calculator, pre-threshold risk states, 4/8/12-week rules, prioritised action queue, weekly return pack.	Unit/integration/cross-tenant tests pass and proactive action generation is proven.
Phase 2 - NCS claims & co-payment	Claim versions, fee/hours/subsidy/discount calculator, billing mismatch alerts, PDF/CSV summaries.	Mandatory-field and historical-version tests pass.
Phase 3 - ECCE & Programme Readiness	ECCE preparation, sensitive identifier controls, service calendar, fee table/readiness checklist.	Permission/security review passes.
Phase 4 - Core Funding	Shadow profile, room/staff drift detection, Review & Confirm preparation.	Comparison accuracy signed off with test dataset.
Phase 5 - AIM	Restricted AIM case workflow, consent/evidence, application-preparation support.	Privacy/permission review required before enabling.
Phase 6 - future approved integration	Implement approved Hive API/import adapter only if supported/authorised.	Contract/API documentation and security review required.

19. Definition of Done

- Feature is additive and does not break existing Creche Wise workflows.
- All funding records are correctly tenant-scoped and permission-protected.
- Weekly NCS rules produce deterministic, explainable results from test attendance data.
- New/edited NCS claim workflow models the 31 July 2026 co-payment requirement.
- ECCE preparation supports the current registration data and AIM L7 session dependency.
- Programme Readiness dashboard tracks current required organisation/service/PAU/user/bank/Tusla/minimum-number/Fee Table/Service Calendar/Parent Statement items as applicable.
- Core Funding shadow profile can identify relevant drift without duplicating live operational data.
- No undocumented automated Hive login or submission is implemented.
- Exports are generated from immutable verified snapshots.
- The Funding & Hive Centre is event-driven/proactive: qualifying operational changes can create or update funding actions without the manager manually opening the module.
- The implementation goes beyond competitor parity: CSV/report generation, NCS tracking and threshold alerts alone do not satisfy Definition of Done.
- Each funding action explains what changed, why it matters, what should be reviewed/done, the applicable due date and the values/evidence prepared by Creche Wise.

- Cross-module impact detection is covered for at least attendance, fees/contract hours, staff, rooms/capacity and service-calendar changes.
- Cross-tenant, sensitive-data, permission, unit, integration and E2E tests are green in CI.
- Feature is merged through PR only after code review and a security review of the new sensitive-data paths.

20. Claude Code execution prompt

COPY THIS INTO THE IMPLEMENTATION TASK

Treat this PDF as an implementation addendum to the existing Creche Wise codebase. Inspect the repository before making changes. Reuse existing domain entities and services wherever possible. Create a repository impact assessment and implementation plan first, then implement phase-by-phase using feature branches and pull requests. Do not rewrite the application, do not duplicate existing operational data, do not weaken tenant isolation, and do not automate direct Hive login/submission without an approved integration. IMPORTANT: do not implement only competitor parity. One-click exports, NCS trackers, CHICK alerts, Pobal-ready reports and under-attendance warnings are baseline. Build the Funding & Hive Centre as a proactive compliance automation engine that listens to normal Creche Wise operational changes, detects funding consequences early, creates prioritised explainable actions, and tells the manager what changed, why it matters, what must be reviewed or done, by when, and which verified values/evidence are ready. Every compliance calculation/action must be explainable, versioned, tenant-scoped and covered by tests.

20.1 Required Claude output before coding

- Current architecture summary and technology stack.
- Existing modules/classes/tables/routes that will be reused.
- Gap list: new tables/services/routes/screens required.
- Database migration plan and rollback considerations.
- Security/privacy impact assessment for CHICK, PPSN and AIM data.
- Feature branch plan and sequence.
- Test plan mapped to the acceptance scenarios in this document.
- Competitive-gap implementation map showing which capabilities are baseline parity and which Creche Wise behaviours provide proactive differentiation.
- Event-source map showing which existing domain changes (attendance, fees, staff, rooms, calendars, funding dates) will trigger proactive compliance evaluation.
- Any conflict between this document and the existing codebase, with the safest proposed resolution.

21. Product outcome

When this addendum is implemented, a childcare manager should be able to maintain children, attendance, schedules, fees, staff, rooms and calendars in Creche Wise as normal. The Funding & Hive Centre should continuously transform those operational records into a small, prioritised list of Hive actions, complete with validated values and evidence. It should identify emerging compliance risk before key thresholds where the rules allow reliable prediction, and detect funding impacts caused by ordinary operational changes without requiring the manager to know which Hive rule to check. The manager should no longer need to manually inspect every child, count weeks of under-attendance, recalculate co-payments, retype basic ECCE details or reconstruct the current service/staff/room picture for each funding review.

TARGET EXPERIENCE

One operational record. Reused for attendance, billing, funding preparation, compliance evidence and reporting. Hive remains the official portal; Creche Wise removes the duplicate administration around it.

22. Research references

- [S1] NCS Policy Guidelines effective from 5 June 2026 - provider attendance/weekly return rules, 4-week absence, 8/12-week under-attendance. [Source](#)
- [S2] Fingal County Childcare Committee, NCS changes over Christmas period - weekly returns available Sunday, due Tuesday; subsidy suspension if not submitted. [Source](#)
- [S3] NCS Compliance Approved Provider Guide 2025/2026 / provider compliance guidance - weekly return accuracy, leavers, 4-week absence and under-attendance controls. [Source](#)
- [S4] Early Years Team announcement, 31 July 2026 - NCS mandatory co-payment functionality live for new and edited claims; calculation inputs and PDF/CSV printouts. [Source](#)
- [S5] Westmeath CCC - ECCE child registration workflow: parent details, child details, PPSN, address/Eircode, registration period. [Source](#)
- [S6] Wicklow CCC - ECCE 2026/2027 registrations: correct AM/PM ECCE session is important for AIM Level 7 funding. [Source](#)
- [S7] Offaly CCC - Programme Readiness 2026/2027: organisation/service details, PAU, portal users, bank, Tusla, ECCE minimum numbers, Fee Table, Service Calendar and Parent Statement. [Source](#)
- [S8] Laois CCC - Core Funding overview: Service Profile plus Application Module; service/staff data and room/session capacity. [Source](#)
- [S9] Fingal CCC - May Review & Confirm 2026 requirements and update-due-date actions. [Source](#)
- [S10] Fingal CCC - August Review & Confirm 2026/2027: current Service Profile plus Fee Table/Parent Statement and approved application. [Source](#)
- [S11] AIM Policy and Rules 2025/2026 - applications via Hive, Access and Inclusion Profile information and provider obligations. [Source](#)
- [S12] AIM - Level 7 Simplification Update, 27 July 2026. [Source](#)
- [S13] PSB Data Catalogue - National Childcare Scheme dataset; API Available: No. [Source](#)
- [S14] PSB Data Catalogue - Early Years Platform dataset; API Available: No. [Source](#)
- [S15] Fingal CCC - Core Funding application changes and operating weeks, August 2026. [Source](#)
- [S16] Westmeath CCC - May Review and Confirm 2026 and Updated Service Profile. [Source](#)
- [S17] HavenLink - publicly advertised ECCE/NCS billing engine, automated attendance status and one-click weekly HIVE CSV export. [Source](#)
- [S18] CrecheHQ - HiveSync publicly advertises ECCE/NCS Hive file imports, registration matching and hours/registration reconciliation. [Source](#)
- [S19] Tot Tracker - NCS compliance monitoring and public announcement of Hive Updating functionality expected late 2026. [Source](#)
- [S20] Little Vista - NCS/Core Funding compliance support, CHICK management, under-attendance flagging and Pobal-ready reports. [Source](#)
- [S21] Child Paths - NCS tracker/alerts, CHICK expiry alerts and Pobal-ready reports. [Source](#)
- [S22] EYCEsoft - childcare platform focused on managing ECCE/NCS funding programmes and compliance. [Source](#)

Research note: Early Years funding rules and Hive workflows can change during a programme year. The implementation should therefore make deadlines, thresholds, required fields and programme-year rules configurable and versioned. This document is a product/technical implementation specification, not legal advice.